STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			P-3200
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA GREG LONDON SHERIFF	DATE ISSUED 06/01/06	DATE REVISED **02/09/23**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE ROAD PATROL	RESOURCES NATIONAL LAW ENFORCEMENT AND CORRECTIONS TECHNOLOGY CENTER INTERNAL REVENUE SERVICE CODE			
SUBJECT PATROL UNIT	CROSS REFERENCE G-4300 Sheriff's Office Vehicles P-3410 Response Status P-4100 Pursuits			

I. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines for the maintenance and operation of patrol units.

II. Policy

Each road patrol deputy shall be assigned a marked patrol unit. These units serve as a mobile base of operations for the road patrol, and due to the extreme nature of the requirements for the patrol units, they must be maintained to the highest standards. The safety and effectiveness of the road patrol deputies can be directly correlated to the maintenance of the road patrol units. Also as the most visible of Sarpy County Sheriff's Office vehicles, patrol units must be operated in a prudent manner.

III. Procedures

A. Patrol Unit Maintenance-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. Deputies shall only drive assigned patrol units.

a) If the deputy's assigned patrol unit is not available, the deputy must be assigned a unit by his or her shift supervisor for that tour of duty.

b) If a deputy must change units during his or her tour of duty, the deputy must notify his or her shift supervisor.

2. Each deputy shall complete an inspection of his or her patrol unit prior to leaving the Sheriff's Office.

a) Each deputy shall ensure the equipment in the assigned unit is present and functioning properly. If any equipment is missing, the deputy shall immediately notify his or her supervisor.

b) Each deputy shall inspect the exterior of the patrol unit for damage. If unreported damage (old or new) is discovered, the deputy shall obtain a report number, complete an Incident Report, and notify his or her supervisor.

c) Each deputy shall inspect the interior of the patrol unit for damage and cleanliness. Deputies shall pay particular attention to the rear of the vehicle to ensure no contraband or weapons have been secreted into the rear passenger area. Deputies shall lift the rear seat and specifically search this area.

d) If a deputy is required to respond to a call for service immediately after coming on duty and is unable to complete an inspection prior to leaving the Sheriff's Office he or she shall complete the inspection as soon as possible.

e) Deputies shall be responsible for replacing any equipment used during their tour of duty (e.g. forms, medical supplies, etc.).

f) Deputies shall be responsible for the general cleanliness and maintenance of their assigned patrol units.

(1) Deputies shall ensure that the interior and exterior of their assigned patrol units are in an acceptable state of cleanliness.

(2) Deputies shall ensure their assigned units are fully fueled at the end of each shift. If a deputy is unable to comply with this procedure, he or she must notify the on-duty supervisor with that information and the reason.

3. Patrol Unit Maintenance Requests:

a) If a deputy identifies an equipment malfunction (e.g. radar unit, emergency lights, etc.) or a vehicle malfunction (e.g. car will not start, brakes functioning poorly, etc.) he or she shall:

(1) Notify the on-duty shift supervisor.

(2) Complete a Sarpy County Fleet Service Repair/Service Request Form electronically through the county's intra portal. Once completed, deputies shall print a copy of the request.

(3) The printed copy shall be placed on the driver's side front seat of the patrol unit.

b) No patrol unit shall be used if a Repair/Service Request Form has been completed for that vehicle.

B. Patrol Unit Maintenance-Shift Supervisor Responsibilities:

1. Shift supervisors shall ensure that all equipment or vehicle malfunctions are resolved.

2. Shift supervisors shall conduct monthly inspections to ensure all equipment is accounted for and functioning. Shift supervisors shall be responsible for investigating any missing or damaged equipment.

C. Operation of Patrol Units-Deputy Responsibilities:

1. Patrol deputies shall adhere to all general requirements set forth in SOP G-4300 Sheriff's Office Vehicles.

a) Patrol deputies shall make a conscious effort to obey all traffic laws and drive in a courteous manner as an example to all other drivers. Deputies may disregard traffic regulations if responding to an emergency call or when pursuing an actual or suspected law violator so long as he or she does not endanger life, limb, or property.

2. Patrol deputies should avoid behaviors that could compromise the safety and effectiveness of their patrol units. These behaviors include:

a) Driving over speed bumps, curbs or railroad tracks at high speeds
b) Resting the left foot on the brake pedal
c) Idling for extended periods, especially in hot weather
d) Downshifting at high speeds
e) Shifting from drive to reverse while still in motion
f) Putting the vehicle in park while it is still in motion

3. Deputies shall not leave patrol units running unattended (out of the sight of a deputy) with the exception of the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office parking lot. In the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office parking lot, patrol units may be left running unattended for no more than fifteen (15) minutes and the vehicle must be locked while running.

4. **Specific Patrol Units**: The Road Patrol Division is assigned several types of units. Each type of unit requires specific procedural considerations.

a) **Marked All-Wheel Drive Ford Police Interceptors (Utility Model):** A marked all-wheel drive Ford Police Interceptor may engage in emergency operations as defined by policy including pursuits and high speed emergency response.

b) **Special Service Units:** This designation includes pickup trucks and sport utility four-wheel drive vehicles. The National Institute of Justice recognizes that vehicles with this designation are not engineered for high speeds or pursuit driving. (The all-wheel drive Ford Police Interceptors are not considered Special Service Units.)

(1) Operators of these vehicles must use extreme caution exceeding the posted speed limits when responding to emergency calls.

(2) Special service units may initiate a pursuit of a motor vehicle where there reasonably appears to exist imminent danger to the welfare or safety of a member of the public or a peace officer, **AND** involves a serious felony. For the purposes of this policy, serious felonies include, but are not limited to: homicide, kidnapping, felony sexual assault, robbery, 1st Degree Assault on a Peace Officer, or any attempt of these crimes. Deputies operating special service units in a pursuit must use all available emergency equipment, and as soon as another patrol unit becomes available to take over the pursuit, the special service unit shall withdraw. Deputies must also adhere to all procedures in P-4100.

c) **Unmarked Patrol Units:** Unmarked vehicles are defined by the Internal Revenue Service Code as not having painted insignias or words that would otherwise clearly identify the vehicle as a Sheriff's Office vehicle. Grill lights, a siren, or

markings on the license plates are not considered clear markings to identify a Sheriff's Office vehicle.

(1) Unmarked patrol units shall only be assigned by the Patrol Commander.

(2) Unmarked patrol units may initiate a pursuit of a motor vehicle where there reasonably appears to exist imminent danger to the welfare or safety of a member of the public or a peace officer, **AND** involves a serious felony. For the purposes of this policy, serious felonies include, but are not limited to: homicide, kidnapping, felony sexual assault, robbery, 1st Degree Assault on a Peace Officer, or any attempt of these crimes. Deputies operating unmarked patrol units in a pursuit must use all available emergency equipment, and as soon as another patrol unit becomes available to take over the pursuit, the unmarked unit shall withdraw. Deputies must also adhere to all procedures in P-4100.